Example Hill Country Community Hospital

Financial Assistance and Uninsured Discount Policy

Effective date: October 1, 2024

1. Purpose

Example Hill Country Community Hospital is committed to providing financial assistance to patients who are uninsured, underinsured, or otherwise unable to pay for emergency and other medically necessary care, consistent with Section 501(r) of the Internal Revenue Code and applicable Texas law.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to emergency and other medically necessary care provided by Example Hill Country Community Hospital.

All medically necessary services provided by the Hospital are covered by this Policy.

A list of providers who deliver care in the Hospital, showing which providers are and are not covered by this Policy, is in the list of providers available at the Business Office.

3. Definitions

3.1 Household. For purposes of this Policy, the household includes the patient and all family members who live with the patient.

3.2 Income. Household income means the household's net income after taxes and payroll deductions.

3.3 Federal Poverty Guidelines (FPG). The Hospital uses the Federal Poverty Guidelines published by the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services.

3.4 Medically necessary care. Care that is reasonable and necessary to diagnose or treat an illness or injury, as determined by the treating provider.

4. Eligibility for Financial Assistance

4.1 Patients may qualify for financial assistance if household income is at or below 300% of the FPG and the other conditions of this Policy are met.

Patients with household income at or below 200% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines qualify for free care, a 100% discount.

Patients with household income above 200% and at or below 300% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines receive a 50% discount from gross charges.

5. Other Eligibility Conditions

5.1 Assets. Patients whose household liquid assets exceed $5,000 are not eligible for free or discounted care. Liquid assets include checking accounts, savings accounts, and investments. The following assets are not counted: primary residence and household furnishings.

5.2 Residency. To qualify, patients must reside in one of the following Texas counties: Gillespie, Kerr, Kimble, Llano, or Blanco. The residency requirement does not apply to emergency care.

5.3 Insurance. Financial assistance under this Policy is available only to patients who have no health insurance.

5.4 Other programs. Patients are not required to apply for Medicaid before receiving a financial assistance determination.

6. How to Apply

6.1 Application period. Patients may apply at any time within 240 days after the date of the first post-discharge billing statement.

6.2 Required documents. Applicants must attach the following documents:

(a) the most recent tax return;

(b) the last three months of bank statements;

6.3 Where to apply. Completed applications may be submitted:

- By mail to Business Office, 1020 Example Main Street, Fredericksburg, TX 78624.

- In person at Business Office.

6.4 Determination. Applications are reviewed by the Business Office.

6.5 Award period. Approved financial assistance applies to eligible care for 6 months from the date of determination.

7. Billing and Collections

7.1 Amounts generally billed (AGB). The Hospital calculates amounts generally billed using the prospective Medicare method. The current AGB percentage is 35% of gross charges.

7.2 Presumptive eligibility. The Hospital does not make presumptive eligibility determinations; an application is required.

7.5 Collections. The Hospital will not engage in extraordinary collection actions before making reasonable efforts to determine whether a patient is eligible for financial assistance. The Billing and Collections Policy is available free of charge.

Questions: call (830) 555-0600 or write to Business Office, 1020 Example Main Street, Fredericksburg, TX 78624.